HOORVIA — FISH & SHELLFISH INTERNAL TEMPERATURE CHART (CHEF VS USDA)

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet • 125°F Chef Salmon vs 145°F USDA Flake • Tuna, Halibut & Shellfish • US Letter (8.5" × 11")

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■ FINFISH INTERNAL TEMPERATURES: CHEF TARGET VS. USDA 145°F STANDARD

Fish Species & Type	Chef Pull Temp	Chef Rested Target	USDA Safe Standard	Ideal Texture & Flake Cue
Wild King / Sockeye Salmon	120°F–122°F / 49°C	125°F / 52°C (Med-Rare)	145°F / 63°C	Silky, translucent coral center; zero white curd
Farmed Atlantic Salmon	125°F–130°F / 52°C	130°F–135°F / 54°C (Med)	145°F / 63°C	Higher fat content stays buttery up to 135°F
Sushi-Grade Ahi Tuna Steak	110°F–115°F / 43°C	115°F / 46°C (Seared Rare)	145°F (Dry!)	Sear 90 sec/side; ruby-red raw center
Swordfish / Mahi-Mahi Steak	130°F–132°F / 55°C	135°F–138°F / 57°C	145°F / 63°C	Dense meaty steaks; pull before 140°F or they dry
Halibut / Chilean Sea Bass	128°F–132°F / 53°C	135°F / 57°C	145°F / 63°C	Large pearlescent flakes separate gently with fork
Cod / Haddock / Pollock Loin	135°F–138°F / 57°C	140°F–145°F / 60°C–63°C	145°F / 63°C	Lean flaky white fish; turns opaque milk-white
Tilapia / Flounder / Sole	138°F–140°F / 59°C	145°F / 63°C	145°F / 63°C	Thin fillets cook in 5–7 min; flakes easily
Whole Trout / Snapper / Branzino	135°F / 57°C (At Bone)	140°F / 60°C	145°F / 63°C	Dorsal fin pulls out effortlessly when done

■ SHELLFISH, CRUSTACEANS & MOLLUSKS INTERNAL TEMPERATURE CHART

Shellfish / Seafood Item	Pull From Heat At	Final Rested Temp	Visual & Physical Doneness Cue
Lobster Tail or Whole Lobster	135°F–138°F / 57°C	140°F / 60°C	Shell turns bright red; meat turns opaque pearly white
Sea Scallops (Jumbo U-10)	120°F–125°F / 49°C	125°F–130°F / 52°C	Golden-brown crust; sides feel springy, center warm/translucent
Shrimp / Prawns (Large/Jumbo)	135°F–140°F / 57°C	140°F–145°F / 60°C	Pink opaque flesh; curls into loose 'C' shape (not tight 'O')
Crab Legs (King / Snow — Reheat)	135°F / 57°C	140°F / 60°C	Pre-cooked on boat; steam 5–7 min just until piping hot
Maryland Crab Cakes (4 oz)	155°F / 68°C	160°F / 71°C	Contains raw egg/mayo binder; must reach 155°F–160°F inside
Clams, Mussels & Oysters	Shell Opens Wide	145°F+ / 63°C	Steam 5–8 min until shells pop open (discard any that stay shut!)

■ THE 10-MINUTE CANADIAN RULE FOR FISH THICKNESS (AT 400°F–425°F)

Fillet / Steak Thickness	Fresh Fish Cook Time	Frozen Fish Cook Time	Cooking Method Adjustment
1/2 Inch (1.2 cm) Thin Fillet	4 – 5 minutes total	9 – 11 minutes	No flipping needed when baked or broiled
1 Inch (2.5 cm) Standard Fillet	8 – 10 minutes total	18 – 20 minutes	Add +5 min if baking wrapped in parchment/foil (en papillote)
1.5 Inch (3.8 cm) Thick Loin	12 – 15 minutes total	24 – 28 minutes	Sear skin-side 4 min, flip & finish in 400°F oven

CHEF'S PRO TIP: How to stop ugly white 'albumin' protein from oozing out of cooked salmon: Brine your salmon fillets in a bowl of cold water with 1 tablespoon of salt per cup of water for 10 minutes before patting dry and cooking, and pull the fillet at 125°F–130°F instead of 145°F!
USDA SAFE MINIMUM INTERNAL TEMPS: All Poultry & Ground Poultry: 165°F (74°C) • Ground Beef/Pork/Lamb: 160°F (71°C) • Whole Pork, Beef & Fish: 145°F (63°C)

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